



Sketch pad



Magnifying glass

LEARNING MORE ABOUT PLANTS

One of the best ways of finding out more about wild flowers is to draw or photograph them. If you draw them, you will notice many details about their structure, which will help you to identify the plant family. A magnifying glass is very useful for examining leaves and petals more closely.

Collecting seeds and growing plants from them requires patience and care. Stored seeds should always be kept dry. Many seeds will germinate better if they are left in a refrigerator for a few weeks before planting. This cold period simulates the low winter temperatures they may experience in the wild. Large seeds, like those from sweet peas, germinate more quickly if they are first scratched, or scarified, with sandpaper.



Scissors



Camera



Envelopes for collecting seeds

PRESERVING SPECIMENS

Plants can be pressed with a simple plant press. The specimens are laid between two sheets of absorbent paper, which should be changed for dry sheets every day or so. It can take several weeks for specimens to dry out.

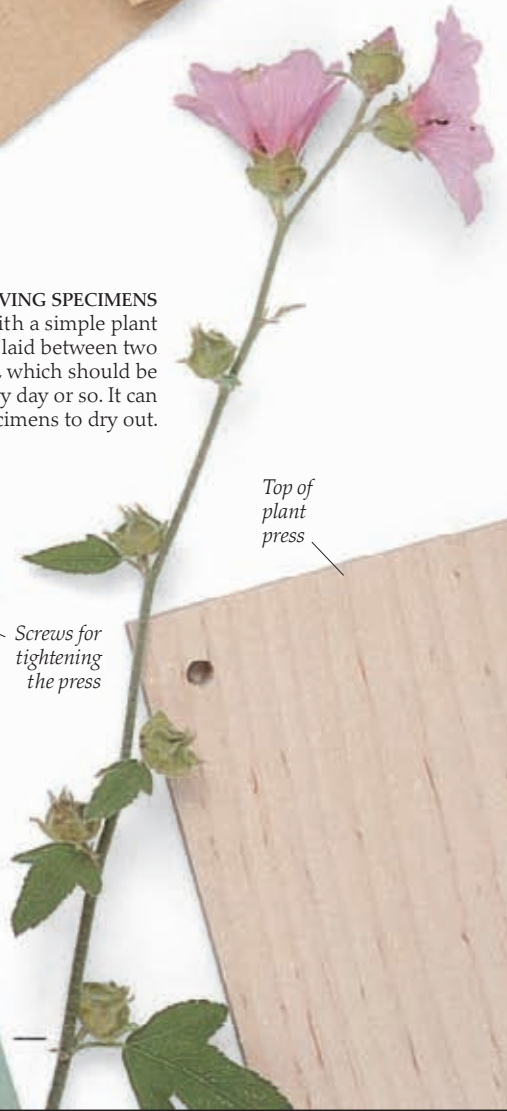


Base of plant press

Simple plant press



Screws for tightening the press



Top of plant press